

SEMI-FINALS**CHAPTER 3 PRELUDE: LEARNING TO LISTEN**Introduction

All throughout this chapter, we will be **listening** to particular samples that will contribute toward will appreciating, understanding, and ultimately cultivating a love for music. There will be discussions of musical concepts and ideas, and listening will be the main reinforcing factor for our comprehension and enjoyment. There is no better substitute to appreciating music than directly exposing the ears, our faculties for hearing, to the vast world of sounds and music out there.

LESSON 1: THE AURAL REALM: Sound, Silence, Music, and Noise

The sense of hearing is one of the most precious gifts God has given to man. However, most of the time we tend to take this gift for granted. With our busy schedules, we do not have much time to enjoy quiet and solitude or hear and appreciate distant sounds from faraway places.

CONCEPTS OF THE AURAL REALM

SOUND - is a wave, a mechanical disturbance in matter that originates from a source and is sent outwards. When two or more objects collide they form vibrations that are transmitted through the air or other mediums. Hearing is the sense that perceives sounds. In humans as well as in most animals, the ear is the sense organ that picks up sounds. The ears also relay the sounds, to the brain which in turn processes these as information. The sounds we hear may be classified as music, language, noise or a mixture of all these.

The spectrum of sound is wide-the human ear can only hear a certain range from this spectrum. This called the audible range. This range depends on two factors; volume and the pitch of the sound. Volume refers to the loudness or softness of a sound and is measured in decibels (dB). Sounds more than 80-90 decibels may be dangerous to human ears when exposed for long duration s. Pitch refers to how high or low a particular sound is and is measured in hertz (Hz). The average hearing range for humans begins at 20 Hz and tops out at around 20,000 Hz.

Some examples of sounds that cannot be heard by humans include: ultrasound, planetary, and other celestial sounds.

SILENCE - is the condition or quality of being quiet, it is basically the absence of audible sound or noise. In music, silence is also very important parts where there is an absence of sound are as important and meaningful as the parts where there is sound.

MUSIC- is the art of organizing and putting together an array of sounds into a meaningful, perceptual experience. Music usually follows certain conventional patterns to convey a message and to express aesthetic, cultural or artistic purposes. Music may be classified into various genres such as classical, popular, jazz, folk and country.

NOISE- is any sound that lacks reference to musical quality and is generally considered unpleasant or unbearable to the human ear.

Music is an abstract form of art maybe even the most abstract and subjective of all the arts. Music in one form or another is perceived to have an effect on many living things. As the saying goes.” Music hath charms to soothe the savage beast. Music appeals directly to our emotions and opens up an avenue to the subjective states of a man.

Lesson 2: Hear Me Out!: Of Voices and Harmonies

“Great melodies create good memories”

What is Melody? The **Melody** is an aspect of music which is probably the first and foremost thing that we remember when we listen to a song or instrumental pieces. The melody leaves a lasting impression in the minds of listeners. For example, when we try to recreate a song, especially one that we hear on the radio, we sing the most familiar part/s of it where the melody is “catchy”. This is usually found in the **chorus** or **refrain** rather than in the **verses**, though some songs may also have remarkable melodies found in the verses. We usually sing, hum or whistle to melody that appeals to us. We also can decide whether a melody is good, mediocre, or plain

trash. Why is it that we can follow a melody? It is because of its very nature. It is because of this nature that musicians usually refer as a “**line.**”

A melody is a group of pitches used in a coherent pattern or succession. Thousands if not millions of melodies have been composed all throughout the world’s music cultures and it is in these melodies that human sentiments have been appealed to most directly. Each melody has different characteristics, some may be happy and cheerful others sombre and melancholic some convict and bring our souls closer to God while others melodies can instill patriotism and spark great acts of courage.

What constitute a melody? A melody is made up of **pitches**. Some parts of melody are high while some are low. Some may also be on the middle register. A **pitch** is the quality of the highness or lowness of a sound. Pitch is very important in music. If sound did not have the quality of pitch, then we would have no distinct tunes or melodies in our songs, for all would sound like a monotonous drone. Take note that even noise has pitch! For example, the barking of dogs, the drilling of jackhammers or an alarm clock going off all has pitches, but they are **indefinite**. This is one reason why these sounds are not normally used as musical material. However, some instruments such as cymbals and the tambourine have no definite pitch, which is why these do not usually carry a melodic line in music.

Interval - the distance between two pitches in music. It may be small as in steps or may be big as in leaps.

INTERVALS

Music Theory

C MAJOR								
	PERFECT	MAJOR	MAJOR	PERFECT	PERFECT	MAJOR	MAJOR	PERFECT
	UNISON	SECOND	THIRD	FOURTH	FIFTH	SIXTH	SEVENTH	OCTAVE
C	C	D	E	F	G	A	B	C

C minor								
	PERFECT	MAJOR	MINOR	PERFECT	PERFECT	MINOR	MINOR	PERFECT
	UNISON	SECOND	THIRD	FOURTH	FIFTH	SIXTH	SEVENTH	OCTAVE
C	C	D	E $\flat$	F	G	A $\flat$	B $\flat$	C

Harmony: Am I tune or out of tune?

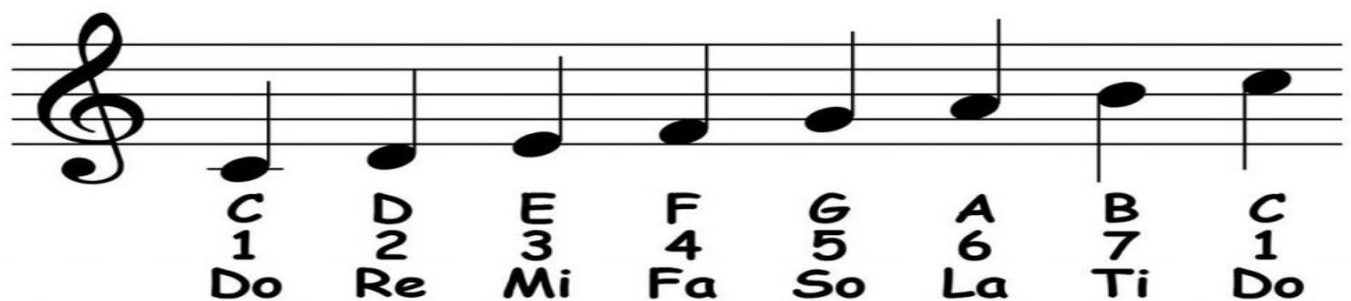
Many of us love to sing. It is great way to express ourselves whether it be an acappella rendition of a hymn at church or a pop song we sing while we take a bath. However, singing lone is not as enjoyable as singing with others, or with accompanying instruments or a background recording. The latter experience has depth, rather than singing just one line. This is where harmony comes in. In the visual arts, such as painting, there is this concept of perspective. Harmony works the same in music. It gives music depth and space.

Harmony is that event in which two or more pitches or notes, sound simultaneously. Of course not all pitch combinations may sound pleasing or harmonious to the ears, hence we have the concept of consonance and dissonance. Consonance is when two or more notes are at rest or resolved with each other, while dissonance is when two or more pitches sound tense or unresolved when heard together. Dissonance may also be referred to as discord. A good example of discord is when someone sings karaoke or videoke out of tune.

Chords; Major-major or major-minor?

Chord - is a device in harmony where two or three pitches are surrounded together. Chords are not chosen randomly, they are derived from a scale. A scale is a set of pitches arranged in a particular sequence and may either run going up (ascending) or going down (descending)

The C Major Scale



In Western music, scales use sol-fa syllables, which are namely: do-re-mi-fa-so-la-tido. Therefore, if we review our interval.

do -do= unison (1-1) (same
note) do -re= second (1-2)

do - mi= third (1-3) do - fa
= fourth 9(1-4) do -sol=fifth
(1-5) do - la= sixth (1-6) do -
ti= seventh (1-7)
do -do= eighth (-18)

The **triad** is a type of chord which is made up of three tones, stacked one on top of the other. It is the most common and basic type of chord employed in the everyday music we hear. Two of the most common types of triad used in music. The major and the minor triad or simply the major and minor chords.

Sound waves and Sound weaves: Texture

Texture in music refers to the various layers of melodic lines and sounds happening simultaneously in a composition.

Monophony, the most basic texture, is a single unaccompanied melody. An example is when someone sings a tune a cappella.

Polyphony is the type of texture when two or more tunes/ melodies are played or sung together at the same time.

Contrapuntal - derived from the word counterpoint is sometimes used interchangeably with polyphony.

An example of polyphonic music is the round song, Row, row, row your boat, sung imitatively in differing time intervals.

Homophony - wherein a melody is accompanied and harmonized simultaneously by chords. Here, the melody is of primary interest while the accompanying chords are subordinate to the melody. A lot popular songs and church hymns have this type of texture.

Dynamics- which is the property of music that deals with its loudness or softness (volume). In music, Italian terms are used to label variations in the loudness or softness of a sound. These terms are written on the score or piece the physical written/printed form of music.

pianississimo (ppp) - very
very soft pianissimo (pp)
-very soft piano (p)-soft
mezzo piano (mp)-

moderately soft mezzo forte
(mf)- moderately loud
forte(f)- loud
Fortissimo (ff)-very loud fortississimo (fff)
- very very loud crescendo (cresc.) -
gradually getting louder < cescrescendo
(deces.) - gradually getting softer >
subito (suddenly) as in; subito forte
-suddenly loud subito piano -suddenly
soft
sforzando(sfz) - sudden strong emphasis

Lesson 3: Hearing Your Heartbeat Makes Me Blush: Rhythm and Timbre

Can you feel my heart beating? I've got rhythm

Music would be meaningless without rhythm. Literally, our lives would stop if our hearts stopped beating..... Figuratively; we would be lifeless if there was no one who made our hearts beat... I know, that sounds cheesy. The same can be said for music.

Rhythm refers to the aspect of time in music. It determines how long or how short a pitch will sound, the employment of time patterns, the length of silences in between notes and also covers the speed of the music. Rhythm in music gives direction and character to each piece as we will see later.

In music we use **beats** or **counts** to measure musical time. Conductors use hand gestures or their baton to wave and count the time when directing an orchestra, choir, or band.

Meter is a repeating pattern of strong and weak beats. In music, there are two common types of simple meter used; **duple and triple meter**. In musical notation, meter is represented with measures or bars. The meter tells us how many beats are there in a single measure.

Duple meter- type of meter where beats are grouped in twos. The best example of this is a march, reflecting the movement of our two feet. ONE TWO, ONE TWO, ONE TWO; or left right, left right

1 2 1 2 1 2

(One is the strong beat, two is the weak beat)

Or

ONE TWO THREE FOUR, ONE TWO THREE FOUR

1 2 3 4 1 2 3 4

(One and three are the strong beats, while two and four are weak. Note: Beat one is slightly stronger than beat three, even if both of them are considered strong beats.)

Triple meter- type of meter where beats are grouped in threes. An example of song that uses this meter is "Bahay Kubo".

ONE TWO THREE, ONE TWO THREE

1 2 3 1 2 3

(One is the strong beat, while two and three are both weak beats)

In music, meter is not always realized too strictly, or else it would be sound too "square", as if it was manipulated by a robot. MIDI files would sound like this. In reality, rhythm and meter are organic, such as reflected in the natural ways we do things, such as walking, breathing, or even the beating of our hearts.

Rubato is one the concept of classical music which literally means "robbed time". When doing a rubato, musicians stretch the rhythm of the music, the meter wavers. Shifting gears-the fast lane and the slow

If the meter tells us how many beats or counts there are in a measure then tempo on the other hand lets.us know how quickly or slowly these beats happen. Tempo dictates the pace of music, and it sets the mood and gives character to the piece. Tempo markings are written in Italian, for Italian music had dominated the cultural life of the European continent from around the late 1500"s to the mid-1700's . The tempo means "time" in Italian.

Grave	very slow and solemn
Largo	broad and dignified
Larghetto	a little less slow than largo
Largamente	in a broad, slow manner slow, relaxed at a walking pace slightly faster than Andante
Adagio	
Andante	
Andantino	
Moderato	
Con moto	
Allegretto	a little lively happy, quick lively, with life, quickly
Allegro	
Vivace	
Presto	very fast
Presstissimo	very very fast
Presto Possibile	as fast as possible

Other terms used in conjunction with abovementioned terms:

poco	a little
poco a poco	little by little
accelerando	gradually getting faster
ritartando,rallentando	gradually getting slower
molto	much
piu	more
meno	less
non troppo	not too much
assai	very
a tempo	back to original tempo, in time
marcato	markedly with emphasis
semplice	simply

lunga	long, held pause
tempo primo	return to the original, initial speed of the piece

Along with these mood or character markings are also sometimes used together with tempo markings. Just like in dynamics, these try to convey human feelings and emotions.

Affettuoso	with emotion
Agitato	agitated
Animato	animatedly ,with life
Con calore	with warmth
Con fuoco	with fire
Cantabile	in a singing manner
Doloroso	with pain and sadness
Dolce	sweetly
Espressivo	expressively
Giocoso	with humour
Grazioso	gracefully
Leggiero	lightly
Morendo	in a dying manner
Scherzando	jokingly
Tranquillo	calmly

In classical or art music, these Italian terms are still widely used today. However, in more recent times, composers have been using the language of their origin (English, French, German, and Filipino) to indicate expressive markings in their music. In jazz music, English is most widely used.

Musical Watercolors

Simply put, **tone color or timbre** is the quality of the notes we hear in music, dependent on the instruments, voices and the method of how these instruments and voices are played /manipulated. We use imprecise adjectives to describe each tone color that we hear, but normally people can easily differentiate what the sound

of a trumpet is from that of a guitar. The most distinct tone color is that of the human voice, which is what most other instruments try to imitate. There is such a wide array of musical timbres available for the human ear to listen and appreciate, especially since in modern times much composed music is created, manipulated, and synthesized using electronic media, computers, and advanced composition software.

LESSON 4: Functionality or Fashion? Forms and Styles

Factory Settings: Forms in Music

Form - in a musical work's shape, structure and the organized arrangement of its elements and how these elements are manipulated so that work makes sense. For hundreds of years, composers have been creating music-even large scale works such as concertos, symphonic poems and operas. Form is widely employed in all other arts, in poetry, literature, sculpture and architecture.

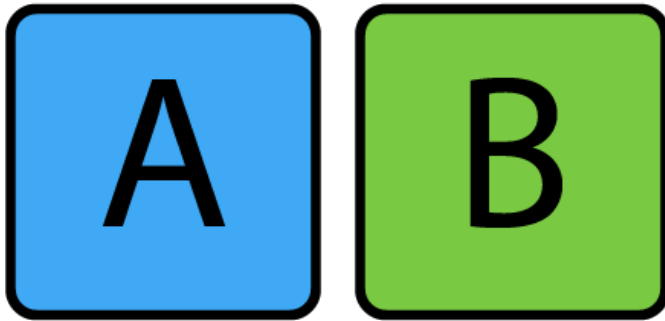
There is duality in how musical elements are utilized. These are by **repetition and contrast**.

Letters are conventionally used to label repetitions and contrasts. For example, if a form is labelled A B A, then A signifies the repetitions while B signifies the element of contrast.

TWO AND THREE PART FORMS

Two part (**Binary**) and three-part (**Ternary**) forms are most commonly used in Western music.

Binary Form- a type of musical form with two contrasting parts. (A" part B" part).
Sample Illustration:



Ternary Form - a type of musical form with three parts. The first part "A" is repeated after the second part "B." This makes this form symmetrical. Sample Illustration:



Style; Variety in Artistic Expression

Style, just like form is another of those vague and general terms we use. What is a style? In music, it is the combination of characteristics and attributes that make it unique. Geography, history, belief systems, values, traditions, lifestyles, and culture all play important factors that shape different musical styles.

LESSON 5: NO MUSIC, NO LIFE!: Its Value and Roles in Society

The Roles of Music

I. As an art form:

1. As medium for self-expression

2. A vehicle for the transmission (either oral or written) of cultural ,artistic heritage
3. A tool for preservation of a nation's identity
4. Used as entertainment: touches human emotions and ennobles the human spirit
5. Away of learning about the traditions, values, attitudes, performing styles, beliefs, sensibilities and culture of a particular people, place, or period in history
6. Showcases the human race's talent and artistic capability

II. in Politics:

1. Used to influence people, their mindsets and their attitudes toward the government
(Example: protest songs, songs calling for unity)
2. Used in political campaigns /advertisements
3. Instill a sense of patriotism and nationalism

III. in Business/ Commerce

1. Used with product advertisements both in mass media (TV, radio, newspapers) or in social media
2. To create a specific atmosphere/ambience in a business location (example: hotels)
3. Background music (BGM) for video gaming industry
4. Background music for both television and movie films

IV. Spiritually:

1. Used in rituals /ceremonies of tribes or other ethnic groups
2. Integral part of religious services
3. Medium for worshipping God

V. In Healing

Music therapy- the use of music in conjunction with either medical or naturopathic treatment of bodily ailments.

VI. Aide in Cognition:

Music is known to help enhance the learning performance of students by actively using skills such as critical thinking, decision making, discipline, and refining motor movements. Music easily relatable to other art forms such as painting, sculpture, poetry, and literature, but can also be related to other subjects such as mathematics, geometry, and values formation.